

The Level Ladder, key and diagnosis

WHAT THIS IS MEASURING

Six parts, one per unit of New Close-up B2 Split A. The class has not studied any of it yet, so a low total is expected and is not the point. Each part is four grammar items and two vocabulary items from the unit's own topic set. The grammar scores tell you what you can move through quickly. The vocabulary scores are a rough signal only, since the book's glossary is new to them. Several items are deliberate B2 discriminators rather than B1 revision: 9 and 10 separate *used to* from *be used to*, 14 and 15 separate past perfect simple from continuous, 27 is a perfect modal, and 32 turns on *stop* plus infinitive of purpose. Those four are the ones worth looking at first.

Answer key, 36 marks

	ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS		ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS
1	is worrying	1	present continuous, temporary	19	will be living	4	future continuous
2	tastes	1	stative verb, not continuous	20	will have been finished	4	future perfect passive
3	think	1	think as opinion, stative	21	are going to drop	4	going to, present evidence
4	are getting	1	continuous, changing situation	22	leaves	4	present simple, timetable
5	embarrassed	1	emotions, -ed against -ing	23	outskirts	4	cities
6	stubborn	1	personality adjectives	24	bustling	4	describing districts
7	was passing	2	past continuous, interrupted	25	mustn't	5	prohibition, not absence of obligation
8	would	2	would, repeated past action	26	might	5	modals of probability
9	used to	2	used to with a stative verb	27	should	5	perfect modal, criticism
10	am used to	2	be used to plus noun	28	can't	5	deduction, impossibility
11	ritual	2	traditions	29	backup	5	compound noun
12	parade	2	festivals	30	attachments	5	technology
13	had already started	3	past perfect, earlier past	31	waiting	6	verb plus -ing
14	had been running	3	past perfect continuous, duration	32	to tie	6	stop plus infinitive of purpose
15	had cut	3	past perfect simple, result	33	taking	6	preposition plus -ing
16	had lost	3	past perfect before a past point	34	to get	6	verb plus infinitive
17	determination	3	success nouns	35	course	6	sports venues
18	inspire	3	fame and influence verbs	36	laps	6	sports nouns

Marking the extra message. Do not mark it out of anything. Read it for three things only: does she control tenses beyond the present, does she link ideas with anything more than *and* and *but*, and is the register appropriate to a note to a teacher. Those three are the whole FCE Writing diagnosis at this stage.

Who knows what

Marks by unit, 6 per unit

UNIT	MARTA	ELENA	AINHOA	VALERIA	SONIA
1 Jump for joy (Q1 to 6)					
2 Global culture? (Q7 to 12)					
3 Role models (Q13 to 18)					
4 City living (Q19 to 24)					
5 Emerging technologies (Q25 to 30)					
6 Take it easy (Q31 to 36)					
TOTAL / 36					
Wrote the extra message?					

The four discriminators, tick if correct

ITEM	MARTA	ELENA	AINHOA	VALERIA	SONIA
9 and 10 used to against be used to					
14 and 15 past perfect simple against continuous					
27 perfect modal					
32 stop plus infinitive					

A student who gets a high total but misses all four of these is a B1 student with good exam instincts, not a B2 student. That is the distinction this sheet exists to make.

Reading a single unit column

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR THAT UNIT	WHAT TO DO
5 or 6	The grammar is already there. The unit will be revision plus new vocabulary and the exam task.	Move fast through the grammar pages. Spend the time on Use of English and Speaking.
3 or 4	Partly there, usually the form but not the choice between two structures.	Teach normally. Add one contrast drill on the exact pair she confused.
0 to 2	New. Do not assume any of it.	Budget a full extra session. Start from meaning, not from the rule.

Reading the total

/ 36	WHERE SHE IS
30 to 36	Already operating at B2. Split A will not stretch her on grammar. Plan extension and push her towards the harder FCE papers early.
22 to 29	Solid B2 entry. The book is correctly pitched.
14 to 21	Strong B1 moving into B2, which is normal for the first Friday of an FCE year. Expect the grammar load to feel heavy until Christmas.
0 to 13	Below the book's entry point. Check first whether she was guessing at random, then plan B1 consolidation running alongside Unit 1.

After marking, answer these three

Which unit scored lowest across the whole class?	
Who is furthest ahead, and what will you give her?	
Who is furthest behind, and what is the first thing to fix?	

Timing, 2 hour Friday slot. Allow 30 minutes for the 36 questions and 10 for the message. That leaves roughly 75 minutes. Do not mark it in front of them. Go straight into the Unit 1 opener, Student's Book pages 5 to 7, teacher's notes at PDF page 20 of *Close_up_B2_Teachers_Book.md*, and bring the results back next Tuesday with the plan already adjusted.